END OF DÉTENTE BEGINNING OF NEW COLD WAR

Causes of New Cold War

Soviet invasion of Afghanistan was perceived by the then US President, Jimmy Carter as “Soviet Aggression in Afghanistan—unless checked—confronts all the world with the most serious strategic challenge since the Cold War began”. He retaliated by proclaiming the famous **Carter Doctrine**, which declared America’s willingness to use military force to protect its interests in the Persian Gulf. He proclaimed that “any attempt by any outside force to gain control of the Persian Gulf region will be regarded as an assault on the vital interests of the United States. It will be repelled by the use of any means necessary, including military force”.[17] The overthrow of the Shah of Iran, in 1979, gave impetus to the American Plan for Rapid Deployment Force under consideration. The United States tried to secure bases in Kenya, Somalia and Oman in order to protect the American interests in the Indian Ocean and Persian Gulf regions. Along with this, he tried to organize a worldwide boycott of the 1980 Moscow Olympics and suspended the US grain exports to the Soviet Union.

Further the non-ratification of the SALT II by the American Senate also increased tensions between the superpowers. The Soviets were bitter regarding the US involvement in Nicaragua, Grenada and El Salvador. The Americans, on the other hand, were critical about the Soviet activities in Angola and the Middle East.

At this critical juncture the ascendancy of Ronald Reagan to the Presidency of the United States led to the beginning of a **New Cold War.** Brezhnev, in October 1982, admitted “Russia declares détente with the USA as dead”.

President Ronald Reagan and his Russian counterparts, first Andropov and then Chernenko, soon got embroiled in a barrage of confrontational rhetoric. Reagan declared that Soviet Union “underlies all the unrest that is going on” and considered the Soviet Union as the “focus of evil in the modern world”. American statements regarding the use of nukes and military intervention in Grenada and Libya and US activities in Central America, especially